

Manqi Wang

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Current positions: Researcher / Academic Writing Tutor

Current institutes: The Bartlett School of Planning / Academic Communication Centre, UCL

EDUCATIONAL BACKGROUND

PhD in Planning Studies/Urban Studies 2018–2025

The Bartlett School of Planning, UCL, London, the United Kingdom

- Thesis: *Micro-regeneration in China: A case study of Guangzhou*
- Supervisors: Prof. Fulong Wu and Prof. Fangzhu Zhang

MSc in International Planning (RTPI accredited) 2016–2017

The Bartlett School of Planning, UCL, London, the United Kingdom

- Average Score: 68% (Merit)
- Dissertation: *Incremental urban redevelopment: A case study of Yongqingfang redevelopment project in Enning Road, Guangzhou* (Distinction)
- Supervisors: Prof. Fulong Wu and Prof. Nicholas A. Phelps

Erasmus Exchange Programme 2014–2015

Faculty of Architecture, Cracow University of Technology, Cracow, Poland

- Average Score: 92.90% (ranked top 10 of the Programme)

BEng in Urban Planning 2011–2016

Guangdong University of Technology, Guangzhou, P.R.China

- Average Score: 90.48% (ranked the 2nd of the School)

RESEARCH & TEACHING INTERESTS

Urban redevelopment, Urban governance, Gentrification, Urban inequalities, Global East/South

RESEARCH STATEMENT SUMMARY

I am an interdisciplinary researcher at UCL specialising in urban governance and urban inequalities within urban redevelopment. Following the award of my PhD in Planning Studies/Urban Studies (Feb 2026), I am currently a Researcher working on ChinaUrban, a major project funded by a €2.49M European Research Council (ERC) Advanced Grant. I have a proven track record in high-impact knowledge dissemination, including authoring peer-reviewed articles, books, and book chapters, as well as producing planning consultancies for local authorities and university-wide pedagogical resources for UCL students. As an active contributor to the wider discipline, I have organised international workshops and seminars, and have presented at more than ten (inter)national conferences. In addition, I serve as a regular peer reviewer for over 15 international academic journals in the social sciences. I am fully trilingual (English, Cantonese, and Mandarin) with extensive qualitative expertise. I commit to bridging the knowledge gap between the Global North and Global East by advancing critical understandings of contemporary social and political transformations in urban redevelopment.

SELECTED RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Researcher, University College London

2026

- Working on the ChinaUrban project funded by the European Research Council (ERC) under the European Union's Horizon 2020 research and innovation programme (Grant Agreement No.832845, Advanced Grant)
- My work includes conducting research on urban China, in particular, I am preparing a draft on the changing role of the state in China through the lens of micro-regeneration; coordinating and producing a short documentary summarising key research findings of the project; delivered a guest lecture for UCL postgraduates on micro-regeneration; and contributed to the project's official website contents on urban redevelopment

Research Assistant, University College London

2021–2025

- Assisted Prof. Fulong Wu on the ERC project (Grant Agreement No.832845, Advanced Grant)
- My work included conducting fieldwork in China; exploring new governance approaches and characteristics of recent regeneration policies and practices, as well as examining socio-spatial impacts of the regeneration projects; disseminating research findings at international conferences; organising research workshops and seminars; and co-organising China Planning Research Group (CPRG) events

Research Assistant, Minzu University of China

2021–2024

- Assisted Dr. Siyao Liu in a national grant application on the research topic: *The role of neighbourhood governance in cities in China and the UK amidst the COVID-19 pandemic* (granted by the National Social Science Fund of China, Project No.21CSH015)
- My work included drafting part of the application form that was relevant to neighbourhood governance; conducting fieldwork in cities of Guangzhou, Shenzhen, and London; interviewing diverse social groups, such as members of neighbourhood committees, local residents, migrants, different-tier government officials, and community planners

Research Assistant, South China University of Technology

2018–2019

- Assisted Prof. Shifu Wang on the project on resilient cities and urban regeneration funded by the National Key Research and Development Plan of China (Project No.2018YFC0704603), General Project of National Natural Science Foundation of China (No.51878285), and Guangdong-Hong Kong-Macao Greater Bay Area (GBA) Development Guangzhou Think Tank Key Topics of the Year of 2018 (No.2018GZWTZD25)
- My work included conducting comparative studies in Guangzhou, China and New Orleans, the United States to investigate the social impacts on neighbourhoods that were affected by natural disasters; and publishing a peer-reviewed article in a leading journal

ACADEMIC PUBLICATIONS

Articles in Peer-reviewed Journals

- Liu, S., Shen, J., **Wang, M.**, Han, Z., & Wu, F. (under review). Cross-border migrant settlements under state entrepreneurialism: A case study of Yanjiao Town. *Cities*.
- Liu, S., & **Wang, M.** (2025). Manoeuvring under territoriality: Strategic compliance in China's micro-regeneration. *Transactions in Planning and Urban Research*, 27541223251399072. <https://doi.org/10.1177/27541223251399072>
- **Wang, M.**, Zhang, F., & Wu, F. (2024). "Micro-regeneration": Toward small-scale, heritage-oriented, and participatory redevelopment in China. *Journal of Urban Affairs*, 46(10), 1953–1970. <https://doi.org/10.1080/07352166.2022.2139711> (Recognised as one of the 'Most Read Articles of All Time' in the Journal)
- **Wang, M.**, Zhang, F., & Wu, F. (2022). Governing urban redevelopment: A case study of Yongqingfang in Guangzhou, China. *Cities*, 103420. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cities.2021.103420> (Ranked as a 'Most Read Article' with 85+ citations in the Web of Science Core Collection)
- **Wang, M.**, & Wang, S. (2018). Implication and experience of resilient city: A case study of New Orleans in the United States. *Urban Development Studies*, 25(11), 145–150. [in Chinese].

Books

- Zhu, X., **Wang, M.**, & Wu, S. (in press). *Chinese urbanisation: Unpacking new governance and business modes of urban redevelopment in China*. Social Sciences Academic Press. [in Chinese].
- Zhu, X., Wu, S., & **Wang, M.** (2021). *Cultural heritage and regeneration of Guangzhou's inner-city areas*. Social Sciences Academic Press. [in Chinese].

Book Chapters

- Wang, Y., **Wang, M.**, & Wu, F. (in press). Micro-regeneration in China. In S. Freire Trigo, L. Andres, & M. Raco (Eds.), *New companion to urban regeneration*. Routledge.

Media & Outreach

- **Wang, M.** (2020). *Inclusive design in London's urban regeneration*. Urban China. <http://hdd-group.com/zw/index.php?c=article&id=226>. [in Chinese]. (1,000+ views)

Pedagogical Publications & Educational Resources

- **Wang, M.** (2023). *Critical Thinking and Writing: Barriers and practical tips for Chinese students in academic writing in the United Kingdom*. UCL Moodle. <https://moodle.ucl.ac.uk/course/view.php?id=36246>. (Commissioned for university-wide circulation; 200+ student users)

Policy Reports & Consultancies

- Guangdong Provincial Association of Engineering Exploration and Design. (2022). *Guidelines for community urban regeneration (micro-renovation) in Guangdong Province* (Standard No. T/GDSX 003-2022). [in Chinese].

RESEARCH GRANTS & EXPERIENCE

- Research project: **ChinaUrban: Rethinking China's urban governance** **2022–2026**
European Research Council (ERC) Advanced Grant, 2020–2026, €2,492,786
PI: Prof. Fulong Wu | Position: Research Assistant (promoted to Researcher in 2026)
- Research project: **The role of neighbourhood governance in cities in China and the UK amidst the COVID-19 pandemic** **2021–2026**
National Social Science Fund of China, 2021–2026, ¥200,000
PI: Dr. Siyao Liu | Position: Research Assistant
- Research project: **Research on the integrated protection and evolution of traditional villages in Guangdong** **2020–2022**
National Natural Science Foundation of China (General Programme), 2018-2023, ¥200,000
PI: Prof. Xuemei Zhu | Position: Research Assistant
- Research project: **Research on pathways and countermeasures for manifesting Lingnan cultural characteristics in urban renewal** **2019–2020**
Guangzhou Federation of Social Sciences, 2019–2020, ¥100,000
PI: Prof. Xuemei Zhu | Position: Research Assistant
- Research project: **Research on the identification and planning methods of 'city-industry' spatial synergetic resilience in high-density urban areas** **2019**
General Project of National Natural Science Foundation of China, 2019–2023, ¥600,000
PI: Prof. Shifu Wang | Position: Research Assistant
- Research Project: **Guangdong-Hong Kong-Macao Greater Bay Area (GBA) Development Guangzhou Think Tank Key Topics** **2018–2019**
Guangzhou Philosophy and Social Science Planning, 2018–2019, ¥100,000
PI: Prof. Shifu Wang | Position: Research Assistant
- Research project: **Key technologies of spatial planning and design for water-climate adaptation in new urban areas** **2018–2019**

National Key Research and Development Plan, 2018–2022, ¥3,240,000

PI: Prof. Shifu Wang | Position: Research Assistant

SELECTED PLANNING & EVALUATION PROJECTS

- Planning & evaluation project: **Regional investigation and evaluation of Chinese traditional village protection (Hubei Province)** **2025**
Commissioned by Ministry of Housing and Urban-Rural Development (MoHURD)
Role: Conducted archival work and impact assessments
- Planning project: **Conservation plan for the famous Chinese historical and cultural village (Shangyue Ancient Village), Fogang County, Qingyuan City** **2024**
Award: Guangdong Provincial Excellent Urban Planning and Design Project (Second Prize)
Issued by: Guangdong Territorial Spatial Planning Association
Role: Conducted archival work and historical and cultural analysis
- Planning project: **Special plan for the renovation and improvement of urban villages in the central urban area of Chaozhou City** **2023**
Award: Guangdong Provincial Excellent Urban Planning and Design Project (Third Prize)
Issued by: Guangdong Territorial Spatial Planning Association
Role: Conducted archival work, semi-structured interviews, and non-participant observation
- Planning & evaluation project: **South China Education History Research Base revitalisation analysis** **2021**
Award: Guangdong Provincial Excellent Urban Planning and Design Project (First Prize)
Issued by: Guangdong Territorial Spatial Planning Association
Role: Conducted planning policy analysis
- Planning project: **Raoping County rural construction planning (2018–2035)** **2019**
Award: Guangdong Provincial Excellent Urban Planning and Design Project (First Prize)
Issued by: Guangdong Territorial Spatial Planning Association
Role: Conducted fieldwork, data collection, and planning design

AWARDS & HONOURS

- The Bartlett Research Student Fund (£12,000, The Bartlett School of Planning, UCL, the United Kingdom, 2020–2025)
- The Bartlett Student Conference Fund (£5,000, The Bartlett Faculty of the Built Environment, UCL, the United Kingdom, 2022–2023)
- Top 10 Model Student of Academic Records (Guangdong University of Technology, January 2016)
- ‘Challenge Cup’ National University Student Entrepreneurship Competition–Silver Prize (¥20,000, Ministry of Education of P.R.China, October 2014)
- China National Scholarship (¥10,000, Ministry of Education of P.R.China, December 2012)

INVITED TALKS & CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Invited Talks

- *PhD Viva experience sharing for Academic Communication Centre’s PhD teaching assistants* (UCL, London, the United Kingdom, March 2026)
- *Letchworth: The now and then of the world’s first Garden City* (Beijing Normal University, Letchworth, the United Kingdom, August 2024)
- *Recent policy shift and the changing governance of urban redevelopment in China* (EPIX, Budapest, Hungary, November 2023)

- *Teaching and supporting Chinese students—A cultural awareness workshop* (UCL China Centre, London, the United Kingdom, May 2023)
- *Comparative dialogues in urban redevelopments in East Asia* (The Socially Just Planning Network, UCL, London, the United Kingdom, May 2023)
- *Urban regeneration in the UK: A case study of Kings Cross regeneration* (Tianjin Municipal Commission of Housing and Urban-Rural Development, London, the United Kingdom, November 2022)
- *Governing urban redevelopment: A case study of Yongqingfang in Guangzhou, China* (Workshop of China Planning Research Group, UCL, London, the United Kingdom, October 2021)
- *Kings Cross regeneration in London* (School of Foreign Studies, China University of Mining and Technology, Xuzhou, P.R.China, November 2020)

Conference Presentations & Organisations

- **Presenting:** *Reflecting state entrepreneurialism on urban redevelopment in China* (Urban-China Symposium: Changing Statecraft, London, the United Kingdom, December 2025)
- **Organising & Presenting:** *Participatory planning in China: A case study of inner-city neighbourhoods in Guangzhou.* (The 2025 International Conference on China Urban Development, London, the United Kingdom, July 2025)
- **Presenting:** *Culture and heritage preservation as a tool for urban redevelopment? Evidence from Guangzhou, China* ('Local Cultures – Global Spaces – Communities, People and Place', Conference of Architecture Media Politics Society (AMPS), virtual, December 2023)
- **Presenting:** *Micro-regeneration in China: A new governance mode for a more sustainable urban development?* (Annual Conference of the International Geographical Union (IGU) Commission on Geography of Governance, Budapest, Hungary, September 2023)
- **Organising:** *An urban regeneration policy shift toward a more inclusive and sustainable agenda?* (RGS-IBG Annual international Conference, London, the United Kingdom, August 2023)
- **Presenting:** *Micro-regeneration in China: A path to a more sustainable urban development?* (The Asian Conference on the Social Sciences (ACSS), Tokyo, Japan, May 2023)
- **Presenting:** *'Micro-regeneration': Toward small-scale, heritage-oriented, and participatory redevelopment in China* (Annual Conference of Urban Affairs Association (UAA), Nashville, the United States, April 2023)
- **Presenting:** *Urban regeneration in China: Recent policy shift from property-led redevelopment to micro-regeneration* (Annual Conference of Association of Collegiate School of Planning (ACSP), Toronto, Canada, November 2022)
- **Organising & Presenting:** *Urban redevelopment through 'micro-regeneration'* (Annual Meeting of American Association of Geographers (AAG), New York City, the United States, February 2022)
- **Organising & Presenting:** *Urban redevelopment in China: What model now?* (UCL, virtual, 200+ online participants, October 2021)
- **Presenting:** *Small-scale urban redevelopment in China: A case study of Yongqingfang in Guangzhou* (Annual Meeting of American Association of Geographers (AAG), Seattle, the United States, April 2021)
- **Reporting:** *Evaluation of economic and social impacts of micro-regeneration of Yongqingfang* (an office of Vanke Property Development Company, Guangzhou, P.R.China, November 2019)
- **Presenting:** *Study on the transformation of peri-urbanised population in Guangzhou's urban villages from the perspective of urban resilience* (Asian Regional Conference on Peri Urbanisation, Busan, South Korea, November 2018)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Guest Lecturer, The Bartlett School of Planning University College London	2025–2026
Delivered a one-hour lecture on the topic of micro-regeneration in China for the postgraduate module: <i>BPLN0009: Urban Planning in China: Frameworks, Practices and Case Studies</i>	
Guest Lecturer, Department of Geography Oxford Brookes University	2025–2026
Delivered a three-hour lecture on the topic of comparative gentrification for Year-2 undergraduate module: <i>GEOG5001: Cities: Geographies of the Urban Experience</i>	
Guest Lecturer, The Bartlett School of Planning University College London	2023–2024
Delivered a one-hour lecture on the topic of critical thinking and academic writing for the Year-1 undergraduate module: <i>BPLN0071: Contemporary Cities</i>	
Guest Lecturer, School of Ethnology and Sociology Minzu University of China	2022–2026
Delivered three lectures (each one lasts for 1.5 hours) on the topic of urban regeneration for the postgraduate module: <i>Comparative Urbanism: Tactics for Global Cities</i>	
Guest Lecturer, Department of Geography and Resource Management The Chinese University of Hong Kong	2020–2021
Delivered a two-hour lecture on the topic of ‘Comparative case studies of urban regeneration programmes in the UK and China’ for the postgraduate module: <i>Global Political Economy</i>	
Teaching Assistant across different departments, UCL	2018–2026
- Delivering individual tutorials (each one lasts for an hour) on guiding and assisting students at both undergraduate and postgraduate levels to develop their skills of critical thinking, effective reading, time management, and academic writing, as well as providing constructive comments and essay feedback at UCL Academic Communication Centre (Academic Communication Centre, UCL, 2021–2026) - Led two-hour seminars bi-weekly, and assessed students’ group projects and essays for the Year-2 undergraduate module (BASc0018): <i>Urban Inequalities and Global Development</i> (Department of Arts and Sciences, UCL, 2024–2025) - Led two-hour seminars bi-weekly, and assessed students’ critical summaries for the postgraduate module (BPLN0038): <i>Comparative Planning Systems and Cultures</i> (The Bartlett School of Planning, UCL, 2023–2025) - Delivered weekly individual tutorials (each one lasts for an hour) on essay writing and effective reading for undergraduates (Department of European and International Social and Political Studies, UCL, 2022–2025) - Led three-hour seminars bi-weekly and assessing students’ critical summaries for the Year-1 undergraduate module (BPLN0071): <i>Contemporary Cities</i> (The Bartlett School of Planning, UCL, 2022–2025) - Contributed to seminar discussions and assessed students’ reading notes and final essays for the postgraduate module (BPLN0040): <i>Critical Debate in International Planning</i> (The Bartlett School of Planning, UCL, 2019–2022) - Guided a half-day walking tour, introducing the regeneration area of Canary Wharf and answering project-related questions for the postgraduate module: <i>Comparative Urban Projects</i> (The Bartlett School of Planning, UCL, 2018–2019)	

TEACHING QUALIFICATION & TRAINING

• Training: Supervising Masters Projects and Dissertations, UCL Arena, 2 h	2026
• Training: Introduction to Equality, Diversity & Inclusion, UCL Arena, 0.5 h	2026
• Training: Disclosing and Managing Conflicts of Interest at UCL, UCL Arena 0.5 h	2024

- Qualification: **Associate Fellow** of the Higher Education Academy **2023**
- Training: Enriching Assessment and Feedback Practice at Module Level, UCL Arena, 2 h **2023**
- Training: Student Engagement Strategies: Active Learning Online, UCL Arena, 3 h **2023**
- Training: Associate Fellow Developing Your Application, UCL Arena, 1.5 h **2023**
- Training: Arena One: Teaching Associate Programme, UCL Arena, 25 h **2023**
- Training: Arena Fellowship Initial Guidance, UCL Arena, 2 h **2022**
- Training: Gateway Workshop, UCL Arena, 2.5 h **2019**
- Training: GDPR online training for all staff, UCL Arena, 1 h **2018**

PROFESSIONAL SKILLS & AFFILIATIONS

Reviewer for Peer-reviewed Journals

2021–present

- A regular reviewer for more than 15 peer-reviewed journals in the field of social sciences (* indicates multiple reviews; ** indicates 5+ reviews), including: Habitat International*; Human Ecology; Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*; Journal of Housing and the Built Environment; Journal of Planning Education and Research; Journal of Tourism and Cultural Change; Journal of Urban Affairs*; Journal of Urban Management; Place Branding and Public Diplomacy; Planning Practice & Research; Political Geography; Transactions in Planning and Urban Research**; Urban Design International; Urban Geography*; Urban Studies*

Skills

- Qualitative research methods
- Software skills: AutoCAD, InDesign, Microsoft Office, Sketch Up, and Photoshop
- Using Microsoft Teams, Zoom, Mentimeter, and Moodle in support of teaching

Professional Affiliations

- American Association of Geographers (student member)
- Association of Collegiate School of Planning (student member)
- American Planning Association (student member)
- China Planning Research Group (social media coordinator/student member)
- Royal Town Planning Institute (student member)
- The International Academic Forum (student member)

OTHER ACTIVITIES

- Judge for the 2026 UCL Doctoral School Annual Blog Competitions (UCL Doctoral School, London, the United Kingdom, May 2026)
- Regular Invigilator for undergraduate examinations at UCL on the module (BPLN0069): *Introducing Planning Systems* (London, the United Kingdom, 2020, 2024, 2025)
- Academic Volunteer to facilitate a half-day walking tour on the regeneration of East London (post-Olympics regeneration in Stratford) for the postgraduate from King's College London (KCL) on the module (7SSGN180): *Governing the Sustainable City* (London, the United Kingdom, September 2024)
- Invigilator for an MCQ Exam for the undergraduate module (BPLN0075): *Introduction to Real Estate* (London, the United Kingdom, March 2024)
- PhD Representative of the Bartlett School of Planning at UCL. My role included taking charge of PhD budgets, engaging and contributing to meetings at both the School and the Faculty levels, and organising PhD academic and social events such as Christmas gatherings and Chinese New Year Celebration (London, the United Kingdom, 2021–2022)
- International Observer for the e-journal of *Urban China*. My role included sharing insights and producing online articles for the knowledge exchange of urban development in China and the UK (London, the United Kingdom, 2019–2020)

- Editorial Team Member of the PhD official brochure: *Taking Planning Forward* (fourth edition) for the Bartlett School of Planning. My role included designing the layout of the brochure, contributing to the content, and collaborating with other member to proofread part of the brochure (London, the United Kingdom, May 2019)
- Student Ambassador of Blue Education Ltd. to organise a culture-exchange workshop for undergraduates at Guangdong University of Technology on the topic of UK education systems and programme applications (Guangzhou, P.R.China, November 2018)
- Coordinator of the Bartlett School of Planning to facilitate walking tours (Canary Wharf and Kings Cross regeneration sites) for scholars from the College of Urban and Environmental Sciences, Peking University (London, the United Kingdom, October 2018)
- Coordinator of the Bartlett Faculty of the Built Environment to facilitate academic events (workshops, lectures, and site visits) for delegates from Guangdong Urban & Rural Planning and Design Institute (London, the United Kingdom, September 2018)
- Intern at the Guangzhou Urban Renewal Bureau to draft urban redevelopment policies and facilitate official meetings between government officials, property developers, and research institutes (Guangzhou, P.R.China, Spring 2018)
- Intern at the International County/City Management Association (ICMA) to facilitate business events (lectures, site visits, and business collaboration meetings) for Chinese delegates (Washington, D.C., the United States, Autumn 2017)

LANGUAGES

- Cantonese (fluent in speaking, reading, and writing)
- English (fluent in speaking, reading, and writing)
- Mandarin (fluent in speaking, reading, and writing)